Shortest and best: review

Optimization · Level 1 · Unit check



In this unit

- Pack the truck
- The shortest way
- Puzzles with rules
- Fair turns without clashes

The big ideas

- Keep the rule first, then go for the goal
- Add up the roads, and settle the smallest first
- Cross out what can’t be; guess only when stuck
- No clashes, and fair turns for everyone

Activity: Puzzle stations

1. Truck (5 min): Find the best load on paper.
2. Map (5 min): Find the shortest way.
3. Sudoku (5 min): Solve a 4 × 4 by crossing out.
4. Turns (5 min): Make a fair rota.

Do the stations alone or with a partner, on paper. No device needed.

Let’s discuss

1. Which idea from this unit will you use first?
2. When did a quick way or a quick look fool you?
3. How would you explain fair turns to a younger child?

Exit ticket

- My favourite idea from this unit + where I’ll use it.